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Harm Register / Risk Management

Version 1.0 · August 2026

Next review: August 2027

— IDENTIFY · ASSESS · CONTROL · REVIEW

HARM REGISTER & RISK PROCEDURE

How we find harm, decide what matters, put controls in place, and keep the register alive. Built for plumbing, drainage, hot water, bathrooms, kitchens, roofing and inspection work in Auckland homes.

Draft for review. Issued by Portobello Plumbing Company Limited (NZBN 9429053083524). Ratings are typical for this type of work, not a substitute for the check you do on the day. Residual risk assumes the listed controls are actually used. Add or retire rows as the work changes.

1. PURPOSE

This procedure meets our duty to identify hazards, assess risks, and eliminate those risks so far as is reasonably practicable — or minimise them where elimination is not reasonably practicable (HSWA s30 and the General Risk and Workplace Management Regulations).

2. WHEN WE ASSESS RISK

- **Trade-level:** this Harm Register, reviewed at least annually.
- **Job-level:** a site check on arrival, and a documented check before higher-risk tasks (height, asbestos uncertainty, excavation, confined space, chemical drain work, heavy lifts, live services).
- **Change:** new plant, a different method, a new type of work, or after an incident or near miss.

3. PROCEDURE

1. **Identify** what could harm workers or other people: the task, the place, the plant, the substances, the people (including occupants and the public), and the environment.
2. **Assess** using the matrix below. Score the risk *before* extra controls if you are deciding whether the job method is acceptable, and again as residual risk with controls in place.
3. **Control** using the hierarchy: eliminate → substitute → isolate / engineer → administer (permits, training, procedures) → PPE. Do not jump to PPE because it is easy.
4. **Do the work** only if residual risk is acceptable (Low or Medium with controls used). Extreme residual risk is not acceptable. High residual risk needs Director approval and a tighter method, or the job is deferred.

5. **Monitor and review.** If the site changes, stop and reassess. Update this register when a control fails or a new harm appears.

Anyone may stop work if they reasonably believe serious risk exists. Stopping work is not a disciplinary matter.

4. RISK MATRIX

Likelihood: 1 Rare · 2 Unlikely · 3 Possible · 4 Likely · 5 Almost certain. **Consequence:** 1 Minor (first aid) · 2 Moderate (medical treatment) · 3 Serious (lost time / hospital) · 4 Major (permanent harm) · 5 Catastrophic (fatality / multiple serious). Score = Likelihood × Consequence.

Score	Rating	Action
1–4	Low	Proceed with standard controls. Keep tidy and watch for change.
5–9	Medium	Apply listed controls before starting. Brief everyone on site.
10–16	High	Documented site assessment. Extra controls or a different method. Director aware.
17–25	Extreme	Do not start. Eliminate or redesign. Seek specialist support if needed.

5. SITE CHECK (USE ON ARRIVAL)

- Safe access, parking, animals, children and other occupants?
- Known asbestos, leak history, or previous repairs disclosed?
- Electricity, gas, water isolation points identified?
- Height, roof condition, weather?
- Underground or concealed services if we will cut or dig?
- Manual handling — cylinder, bath, pipe, debris?
- Hygiene, sewage, sharps, underfloor or ceiling space?
- Emergency exit and phone coverage / lone-work check-in?

If the answer to a risk question is “not sure”, treat it as present until you know otherwise — especially asbestos and live services.

6. HARM REGISTER

Inherent ratings assume a typical Auckland residential job without extra thought. Residual ratings assume the controls in this table are used. Owner of all rows: Director. Review date: August 2027 or after an incident.

ID	Hazard / harm	Who	Inherent	Controls (hierarchy)	Residual
H01	Working at height — ladders, roofs, ceilings. Falls, dropped tools, fragile roofing.	Workers, occupants below	20	Eliminate height where we can work from the ground. Stable ladder, three points of contact, tied or footed. No roof work in high wind or rain. Keep people out of the drop zone. Tool lanyards on steep work. Use scaffolding or a roof platform when the job duration or pitch requires it.	8
H02	Asbestos — AC pipe, gaskets, vinyl, soffits, textured coatings in pre-2000 buildings. Inhaled fibres.	Workers, occupants	20	Assume present until ruled out. Do not cut, drill, grind or water-blast suspect material. Stop and arrange survey or licensed removal. Awareness training. If accidentally disturbed: isolate area, wet-clean only as advised, do not sweep dry, notify customer and Director.	6
H03	Manual handling — hot water cylinders, baths, WC pans, pipe, roof iron. Strains, crush, dropped loads.	Workers, helpers	12	Plan the path. Use trolleys, straps and two-person lifts. Drain cylinders before moving. Do not rush a one-person lift up stairs. Warm up and split the load.	6
H04	Electricity near water — shock, arc, secondary fall.	Workers, occupants	20	Isolate power when fittings or wet areas create a shock path. Licensed electrician for electrical work. RCD protection on portable tools. Do not work on live electrical equipment. Treat unknown wiring in older homes as live.	6
H05	Underground / concealed services — strike on power, gas, water, fibre. Explosion, shock, outage, injury.	Workers, public, networks	20	Ask the customer, review plans, locate where practicable, hand-excavate near marked services. Plans are indicative. Emergency stop and notify if a service is hit.	8
H06	Biological / wastewater — sewage, blocked drains, underfloor mould. Infection, splash to eyes.	Workers, occupants	12	Gloves, eye protection, cover wounds. Limit aerosols. Hygiene before eating. Keep occupants clear. Medical advice after significant exposure. Tetanus status up to date.	6
H07	Hot water / heat — scalds, burns from cylinders, pipework, soldering, steam.	Workers, occupants	12	Isolate and depressurise before opening systems. Warn occupants. Gloves and eye protection. Check tempering / thermostat settings on completion. Allow cooling time.	4
H08	Hazardous chemicals — drain cleaners, solvents, adhesives, flux. Burns, fumes, incompatible mixing.	Workers, occupants	12	Least-hazardous product that works. Read SDS. Never mix products. Ventilate. Chemical gloves and eye protection. Store labelled and upright, away from children.	6
H09	Silica and dust — cutting tiles, concrete, plaster. Respiratory disease.	Workers, occupants	16	Avoid dry cutting. Water suppression or on-tool extraction. P2 (or better) respirator when dust cannot be eliminated. Isolate the room and clean with vacuum, not dry sweeping.	6
H10	Power tools and plant — grinders, drills, drain machines, pressure equipment. Cuts, entanglement, eye injury, noise, stored energy.	Workers	12	Guards on, right disc/bit, eye and hearing protection. Loose clothing and jewellery clear of rotating plant. Depressurise before opening lines. Tag out damaged gear.	6

H11	Slips, trips, falls on the level – water, tools, offcuts, poor lighting.	Workers, occupants	10	Manage water as we work. Housekeeping, lighting, mats, signage. Clear a path for occupants. Tidy as we go – the Portobello standard.	4
H12	Confined / restricted spaces – underfloor, ceiling, tanks. Atmosphere, heat, entrapment, unseen services.	Workers	16	Do not enter a true confined space without a safe system (atmosphere, rescue plan, standby). For typical underfloor/ceiling: check access, lighting, vermin, insulation, heat, and electrical cables. Lone-work check-in. Abort if air quality or access is poor.	8
H13	Driving and vehicles – road crash, poorly secured load, reversing on driveways.	Workers, public	15	Licensed, roadworthy vehicle. Loads restrained. No phone use while driving. Fatigue management. Reversing with care around children and driveways.	6
H14	Occupants, children, pets and the public – contact with tools, open trenches, curiosity around the work.	Others	12	Brief the customer. Barrier or close the work area. Cover openings. Never leave hazardous plant unattended. Stop if people will not stay clear.	4
H15	Sharps / needle stick – gardens, underfloor, public areas, bathrooms.	Workers	10	Look before reaching. Tongs/puncture-resistant container if found. Do not recap. Wash and seek medical advice the same day after a stick.	6
H16	Weather and heat – roof work, dehydration, UV, wind, wet surfaces.	Workers	10	Reschedule unsafe weather. Sun protection, water, rest. No roof work when wind or rain makes footing unreliable.	4
H17	Lone work and psychosocial – delayed help, fatigue, aggressive or impaired occupants.	Workers	10	Share location and expected finish. Phone charged. Leave and call for help if a situation feels unsafe. No work while impaired. Debrief after a difficult job.	6
H18	Gas on a customer site – we do not carry out gasfitting. Harm if we disturb a gas installation or stay in a leak. Fire, explosion, CO.	Workers, occupants	20	Out of scope: no gasfitting, appliance install or service. If a leak or gas work is identified, stop, eliminate ignition sources, evacuate if needed, call 111 / the network emergency number, and refer to a licensed gasfitter. Do not isolate or reconnect gas unless it is an immediate life-safety action we are competent to take.	4

7. RESIDUAL RISK WE WILL NOT ACCEPT

- Working on a roof or ladder in conditions we cannot control.
- Disturbing suspected asbestos to “just get it done”.
- Excavating where services are unknown and cannot be located or hand-dug safely.
- Entering a confined space without a safe system.
- Live electrical work, or plumbing work that creates a known shock path.
- Any gasfitting or gas-appliance work – out of scope; refer to a licensed gasfitter.

8. REVIEW AND APPROVAL

The Director reviews this register at least annually and after any notifiable event or repeated near miss. New rows can be added on a job and folded into this controlled version at the next review.

Director / Officer

Jonathan David Ian Elton

Signature · Date**Reviewed with workers**

Name · Signature · Date

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